

Product Case

From DM to Confirmed Order | Social Order Checkout

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1. Problem Statement

Many Nigerian micro and small businesses already sell successfully through WhatsApp and Instagram. The customer sees a product, asks questions and eventually says, “I want it.” At that point, the sale should be simple. Instead, the seller often starts another manual process: sharing payment details, collecting a transfer proof, asking for the buyer’s name, phone number and delivery address, confirming the amount and then searching through chat messages to keep track of the order.

The problem is not product discovery. Buyer and seller have already found each other. The friction begins after purchase intent and before the order becomes confirmed and ready for fulfilment.

Core problem

How might we help a social-commerce seller turn an agreed sale in chat into a confirmed, trackable order without forcing them to abandon WhatsApp or Instagram?

2. Target Users

Primary user: Nigerian micro and small business sellers who receive orders through WhatsApp or Instagram.

- Typical categories: fashion, beauty, food, accessories, home products and other social-first retail businesses.
- They already use chat as their sales channel and may not need a full marketplace or complex e-commerce stack.
- They manually collect payment and fulfilment information after the customer agrees to buy.
- They need a lightweight process that fits into their existing behaviour instead of replacing it.

3. User Needs and Pain Points

User need	Current pain
Clear order information	Product, quantity, amount and payment status can be scattered across multiple messages.
Reliable buyer details	Name, phone number and delivery address are collected manually and can be incomplete.
Simple payment confirmation	Transfer proof and payment status are easy to miss or confuse inside long chats.
One order record	Sellers may have to search old messages to reconstruct what happened.
Low-friction buyer experience	Buyers can be asked the same questions repeatedly after already agreeing to purchase.

4. Research and Evidence

This case uses secondary research rather than invented interviews. The research direction focused on the scale of Nigerian MSMEs, the importance of mobile and social channels in digital behaviour, and how lightweight commerce tools structure the order process.

- PwC Nigeria MSME Survey 2024: used to ground the case in the realities of small-business operations in Nigeria.
- DataReportal, Digital 2026: Nigeria: used to understand the country's mobile and social-media environment.
- Comparable social-commerce and lightweight checkout tools were reviewed to understand common patterns such as link-based ordering, order summaries and simple seller dashboards.

The key insight from the research and product review was that the solution does not need to become another marketplace. The user already has a customer and a conversation. The product only needs to structure the final step from purchase intent to confirmed order.

5. Proposed Solution

A lightweight Social Order Checkout that lets a seller create the agreed order and send one structured checkout link back to the buyer.

1. Seller enters the agreed product, quantity, amount and optional note.
2. The system generates a shareable checkout link.
3. Buyer reviews the order before entering delivery details.
4. Buyer chooses a payment method and completes a simulated payment in the prototype.
5. Buyer receives confirmation and an order reference.
6. Seller sees the order status and fulfilment information together in one place.

6. Value Proposition

For sellers

Turn an agreed sale into a structured, trackable order without replacing the social channel where the relationship already exists.

For buyers

Complete the final checkout step in one clear flow instead of repeating payment and delivery information across multiple chat messages.

7. Product Decisions

- Do not replace WhatsApp or Instagram. The product begins only after the buyer has already agreed to purchase.
- Do not build a marketplace in the MVP. Discovery, search and public storefronts are outside the core problem.
- Keep the seller action lightweight: create order, generate link, track status.
- Simulate payment in the prototype because the assessment is testing product thinking and user flow, not production payment integration.
- Exclude features that do not directly help create, send, complete or track an order.

8. MVP Scope and Prioritisation

P0 means Priority 0: the feature is essential for the MVP to test the core hypothesis.

- P0 - Seller dashboard
- P0 - Create order
- P0 - Shareable checkout link
- P0 - Buyer order summary
- P0 - Buyer name, phone and delivery details
- P0 - Payment choice and simulated payment
- P0 - Order confirmation and reference
- P0 - Seller order details with payment and fulfilment status

Out of scope for the first version: marketplace discovery, inventory management, live logistics integration, CRM, loyalty, discounts, advanced analytics, accounting and AI assistance.

9. Success Metrics

- Primary metric: completed orders through the checkout link.
- Seller activation: sellers who create and share at least one order.
- Checkout completion rate and abandonment rate.
- Payment success rate in a future live-payment version.
- Repeat seller usage.
- Time from order creation to order confirmation.

10. Roadmap

Phase 1 - Prove the workflow: Create order, share link, buyer details, payment simulation, confirmation and seller tracking.

Phase 2 - Support fulfilment: Light inventory, fulfilment statuses, customer history and basic order analytics.

Phase 3 - Support growth: Storefront options, repeat-customer tools, discounts, templates and deeper integrations.

11. Risks and Assumptions

- Some sellers may feel their current chat process is already good enough.
- Some buyers may hesitate to leave WhatsApp or Instagram to complete checkout.
- Direct bank transfer remains a strong preference for many small sellers.
- Adding too much structure could slow a purchase that currently feels quick.
- Trust will matter if the product later handles real payments.

12. Expected Impact

If the hypothesis is correct, the product should reduce the amount of manual back-and-forth required to complete a social-commerce order, give sellers a clearer record of each transaction and make the buyer's final checkout step more predictable.

13. Live Prototype

Prototype: <https://social-order-checkout-assessment.lovable.app>

14. AI Use Disclosure

AI tools were used to support research synthesis, wording refinement, document formatting and prototype iteration. Product framing, prioritisation, final decisions and assessment review were completed and validated by me.